COUNTRY REPORTS: ALGERIA

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Status report

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Algeria's largest commitment of the period was gazetted rather than published: Presidential Decree n° 25-321 approved the National Information-Systems Security Strategy 2025–2029 in the same Journal Officiel issue of 30 December 2025 as the data-governance decree. It was presented on 3 March 2026 by the Ministry of National Defence, through the Information Systems Security Agency, and rests on three objectives approved by President Tebboune: protecting critical infrastructure, securing sensitive state data and ensuring continuity of services. Its home is not incidental — cyber policy is framed explicitly as a matter of digital sovereignty.

The civil programme has a named owner. Digital Algeria 2030, launched in 2023 and succeeded by the National Digital Transformation Strategy 2025–2030, is structured around seven pillars including interoperability and data exchange, with implementation overseen by the High Commission for Digitalisation created by presidential decree on 6 September 2023. The Commission added a fifteen-member Scientific and Technical Committee in Algiers on 23 October 2025, three of its members drawn from the diaspora, under High Commissioner Meriem Benmouloud, the same account carrying its targets of ICT jobs in the hundreds of thousands and a fifth of GDP. The data-governance framework was formally launched on 9 February 2026 at a ceremony presided over by Prime Minister Sifi Ghrieb, which installed a national commission to follow up its implementation. Artificial intelligence is a step behind: the Prime Minister chaired a government meeting on 25 May 2026 that reviewed the draft national AI strategy, with its action plans to follow only once the Council of Ministers adopts it. External support has attached to the same frame: a two-year UNDP cooperation agreement announced in November 2025 and a UNDP project backed by the Japanese government to support the strategy's 2027-2030 executive plan.

The administration expected to deliver it is losing ground on the one long-run measure available. Algeria scored 55.7 of 100 for overall governance in 2023, 18th of 54 African states, 1.4 points worse over five years against an African average that gained 0.1, and its Budgetary and Financial Management score fell 19.5 points over the decade to 47.2, 35th of 54.

Legislation and regulation

Algeria replaced its decade-old electronic-signature regime in February 2026: Law 26-02 of 17 February 2026 sets general rules for electronic trust services and electronic identification, defining electronic identification means and systems at three levels of assurance — low, substantial and high — and creating a National Electronic Certification Authority to supervise trust services. The same law requires trust-service providers to undergo periodic compliance audits by that authority or an accredited auditor, with trusted third parties also open to audit by the information-systems security body. It moved fast: the Council of Ministers approved the draft on 2 November 2025 and it was presented to the National People's Assembly by early December.

The other instrument of the period is Presidential Decree n° 25-320 of 30 December 2025, a twenty-article text in four chapters signed by President Tebboune and gazetted in Journal Officiel n° 87, which puts in place a national data-governance framework for the public sector. It splits supervision three ways — the National Council for Information-Systems Security over the operation of the dispositif, the ANPDCP over personal-data conformity, and the ASSI over security-level classification — and its Article 19 starts the data-classification and data-source-cataloguing duties on public bodies from the date the High Commission for Digitalisation publishes the two référentiels required by Article 8.

Presidential Decree n° 26-07 of 7 January 2026 requires every Algerian public institution, administration and body to create a structure responsible for information-systems security and personal-data protection. Its own machinery is left to texts below it: Article 8 leaves the content, duration and organisation of the new security posts to a joint Finance and Public-Service order, and Article 13 leaves implementation to a Public-Service instruction.

Beneath the recent decrees sits a thinner statutory stack: Law 09-04 of 2009 on offences linked to information and communication technologies, Law 18-05 of 10 May 2018 on electronic commerce, Law 20-04 of 2020 on radiocommunications and Law 18-07 of 10 June 2018 on personal data. Artificial intelligence has no statute: legislation to regulate its ethical use was reported in preparation in November 2025. A general digitalisation law, covering data, digital services, electronic exchange, system security and the responsibilities attached to them, is in the final stages of study according to the High Commission for Digitalisation (September 2026); no draft is published.

Data protection

Algeria's data-protection authority ruled in July 2026 that photographs are personal data: its délibération of 15 July holds that any photograph or video permitting the direct or indirect identification of a natural person falls under Law 18-07, so its collection, storage, retention and publication require a legal basis. Publishing a person's image on a social or digital platform now takes free, explicit, prior and verifiable consent absent a statutory exception, with prior notice of the controller, the purpose, the distribution and the retention period, and the Authority treats platforms whose infrastructure sits outside Algeria as engaging the international-transfer rules of the same law.

It follows earlier texts on workplace video surveillance and on the designation of data-protection officers. The regulator behind them was created by Law 18-07, had its board appointed in 2022, and has exercised investigatory, audit and enforcement powers over all personal-data processing since August 2023; it opened a compliance push on data retention in December 2025, pressing controllers to appoint a data-protection officer and keep a register of processing, and is chaired by Samir Bourehil (2026). Complaints over unlawful publication of images lie to it as well as to the courts. The interior minister ruled the national identification number sensitive data in December 2025, its unlawful use punishable under the data-protection law in coordination with the authority.

The statute was strengthened by Law 25-11 of 24 July 2025, which requires data protection officers, records of processing activities and impact assessments for high-risk processing, expands the authority's enforcement powers, and defines biometric data explicitly. Controllers must notify a breach within five days and affected individuals without delay, with criminal penalties reaching ten years' imprisonment and fines of 10,000,000 dinars, and personal data on Algerian data subjects must be stored on servers inside the country.

Two limits sit around the regime. Article 18 of the December 2025 data-governance decree excludes defence, national-security and judicial data from the framework altogether, while Article 4 subjects the personal data inside it to the existing protection regime rather than setting a new standard. A National Authority for the Prevention and Combating of ICT-Related Crimes monitors electronic communications, and Algeria's Digital Freedom score fell 9.4 points over 2014–2023 to 21.2 of 100, 48th of 54 African states.

Regional collaboration

Algeria has moved from signing continental agendas to convening them: African telecommunications and ICT ministers adopted the Algiers Declaration on African Telecommunications Sovereignty and Integrated Connectivity, a continental agenda covering 2026 to 2030, and Algeria hosted the ministerial meeting that produced it in March 2026.

The bilateral track runs in two directions. Algeria and Tunisia agreed to expand telecommunications and ICT cooperation at the fourth session of their Joint Technical Commission in June 2026, an established recurring mechanism; Algeria and Niger agreed to strengthen cooperation on telecommunications and digital development in March 2026, a southward track alongside the continental role. Northwards, a memorandum of understanding on innovation, digital transformation and smart industry was signed with Italy during President Tebboune's visit to Rome in July 2025.

The multilateral commitments are pledges rather than plumbing. Algeria joined the 50-in-5 digital public infrastructure campaign in March 2026, and the central bank joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System in August 2025, though commercial banks were still completing their own connectivity through 2026. The estate does reach across the border in one place: the Apostille e-legalisation platform went live on 9 July 2026, replacing the manual chain for documents destined for use abroad.

Contact with Smart Africa remains at the level of talks: its chief executive met Minister Sid Ali Zerrouki in Geneva in July 2026 on AI adoption and digital integration, covering the Africa AI Council and Algeria's participation in the Smart Market Initiative. Algeria had also argued at the UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance in Geneva on 6 July 2026 for practical, implementable measures — technology transfer, capacity building and narrowing the digital divide. The Algerian and Nigerien ministers launched operation of the fibre link between In Guezzam and Arlit-Agadez on 6 October 2026, at a starting capacity of 100 Gbps.

Standards

Algeria writes its data standards as a precondition rather than a guideline: under Presidential Decree 25-320 a public body may use the national interoperability system only after classifying its data and cataloguing it against two référentiels to be published by the High Commission for Digitalisation, and a data user needs the issuing body's consent through the system before exploiting data. A binding referential predates them: Executive Decree 19-271 of 7 October 2019 fixed a national interoperability referential that public bodies must write into the specifications of every information system they buy or develop to exchange data, defence and security systems excepted. The framework the newer rules would sit inside is not itself settled — the whole-of-government interoperability framework is recorded as planned or in draft, with the exchange platform it would govern already partly in use (2025). A data-governance body is established as an autonomous institution (2025).

Certification is split in two. Algeria operates a Governmental Electronic Certification Authority for state bodies alongside ARPCE's national certification authority, the regulator having been designated the national electronic-certification authority in January 2025; Law 26-02 has since put a statutory audit duty on trust-service providers. The High Commission is responsible for ensuring that the National Data Centre and National Cloud meet national cybersecurity standards.

Elsewhere standards are enforced through purchasing and accreditation rather than published specifications. The electronic government procurement system in use for online tendering and contract management is used to enforce technical standards (2025), the Council of Government reviewed progress on a national accreditation, conformity

and certification network and its GEOLAB digital platform on 23 July 2026, and the country is accelerating adoption of IPv6 across its networks (July 2026). There is no government open-source policy (2025), and Algeria follows the international information-security standards committee as an observer rather than a voting member (January 2024).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The room to argue about digital policy has narrowed faster than almost anything else Algeria is measured on. Civil Society Space scored 10.9 of 100 in 2023, 50th of 54 African states after a 13.4-point fall over the decade, and Deliberative & Participatory Governance 44.2, 39th, after a 9.0-point fall. Over the same period Media Freedom fell 18.3 points to 33.8, 47th of 54, and Freedom of Expression & Belief 13.6 points to 25.0, 48th — both among the ten most deteriorated of the index's 96 indicators.

The participation machinery is being built regardless. Algeria has a public e-participation platform (2025) and a citizen feedback mechanism for public services, with government responses recorded as reaching back to citizens (2025), and the national police opened an online public-security perception survey in August 2026, reachable by QR code, asking citizens to rate their sense of security so the force can steer operational priorities.

What is under consideration points the other way. The Council of Government examined a draft national information-verification system on 23 July 2026, framed as counter-disinformation and intended to protect the integrity of information and strengthen public trust in digital media. A bill to regulate digital platforms was under examination at the Assemblée populaire nationale in October 2025, and would put content-removal duties on covered platforms and create a regulator attached to the Presidency with powers to fine and to block.

On access to records the position is improving from a low base. Accountability & Transparency is one of Algeria's three worst-scoring governance sub-categories at 30.4 of 100 in 2023, 36th of 54 and below its 2014 level, though disclosure and accessibility of public records both rose over the decade to 2023. Published analysis in Le Matin d'Algérie argues that the state digitises its administrative façades faster than it reforms the mechanisms behind them, so duplication persists, data circulates badly and the citizen still bridges administrations that cannot talk to each other.

Finance

Financial sustainability

Algeria's 5G licences of November 2025 write a standing digital levy into each operator's terms: 3% of turnover towards financing universal electronic-communications service, 0.3% for research, training and standards, 0.2% for the numbering plan, and 1% of 5G turnover on top of a fixed licence fee. The tender of 7 September 2026 to bring mobile service to 3,000 localities of fewer than 2,000 people is financed entirely by the state through that universal-service mechanism.

The budget carries the core systems on its own lines. The interior ministry's programme for digitalising public services was appropriated 303.9 million dinars in payment credits for 2026, up from 103.9 million in 2025, and the treasury's line for modernising information systems and payment instruments 707 million, against 480 million in 2025. The largest line, identity, titles and secure documents, stood at 12.32 billion dinars for 2026, against 12.36 billion in 2025. The 2026 estimates print no financing source against their digital lines (FY2026). No outturn against the digital appropriations had been published as at September 2026.

The digital lines read in the budget rose from 18.98 billion dinars in payment credits for 2024 to 19.56 billion for 2025 and 20.59 billion for 2026, up 5.3% in the latest year, a total that includes lines only partly digital.

Recurrent money reaches below the centre too: more than 110 million dinars from local authorities' 2026 operating budgets is extending the national address register to the wilaya of Timimoun.

MoUs and other agreements

Algeria signed cooperation memoranda with Moscow and London in late 2025: a cybersecurity memorandum between Russia's Positive Technologies and Proxylan, a subsidiary of the state research centre CERIST, and one between the national police force DGSN and the UK Home Office on digital forensics and biometrics for policing. Neither attaches a value or a delivery obligation to the intent.

That pattern runs through the rest of what has been signed. Algérie Télécom and the notarial profession agreed in July 2025 to digitise notarial services; Algeria and Italy signed on innovation, digital transformation and smart industry during a presidential visit to Rome in the same month; Algérie Télécom and Sparkle put their names to a submarine cable linking Italy to Algeria; and Djezzy and INATEL announced a strategic partnership in April 2026 framed around industrial capability and technological sovereignty. None of them states a value, a workplan or a date by which anything must be delivered, which is the difference between a signature and a commitment.

What has produced something is the work with development partners. MPT-CERT, the sectoral cyber incident response centre, opened in June 2026, with South Korea supporting Algeria's cyber-defence capacity through KOICA — an institution running rather than an intention recorded. The agreement with the UN Development Programme of November 2025 and the UNDP project backed by the Japanese government signed in May 2026 both attach to the national digital transformation strategy, and the second runs on an executive plan that begins in 2027, after the period this report covers.

New investments

Algeria approved USD 1 billion to finance African startups in October 2025, announced by the Minister of Foreign Trade and Export Promotion at an African ministerial meeting on the sidelines of UNCTAD16 in Geneva — money aimed at the rest of the continent rather than at Algeria's own digital estate, and money approved rather than moved. The vehicle for it is the African Startup and Young Innovators Financing Fund, launched by President Tebboune in September 2025 and aimed at technology, education, healthcare and humanitarian projects.

Algeria's digital-sector financing in 2025 was its own money. The two commitments on the year are a pledge by the Algerian state to a fund the state created, and spectrum licence money paid to the state by three telecoms operators, two of them domestic or state-linked.

Domestic capital is where the movement is, and it is early. Algérie Télécom announced an investment fund for startups working in artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and robotics at the third CTO Forum Algeria in February 2025 — an announcement rather than capital deployed. At the other end of the year VOLZ raised DZD 600 million, about USD 5 million at the time, in December 2025, the first exit for the Algerian Startup Fund. The state has also waived initial public offering fees for startups until 2028 to draw young technology companies onto the Algiers exchange.

The other large sum in play runs the other way: Algeria's first 5G licences, awarded in late 2025, cost Mobilis, Djezzy and Ooredoo a combined DZD 63.9 billion payable to the state treasury.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Algeria's 5G networks reached every province within months of launch: Ooredoo extended service to all of the country's provinces by March 2026, ahead of a licence plan that opens with eight pilot wilayas and allows six years to reach nationwide coverage, and Djezzy's network was live across 18 wilayas in the same month. The three licences went to Mobilis, Djezzy and Ooredoo in late 2025 for a combined DZD 63.9 billion, about USD 492 million, following a competitive ARPCE tender launched at the end of May 2025.

Fixed access has moved as fast. Fibre-to-the-home subscriptions passed 4 million in early October 2026, from 53,000 in June 2020, with the monthly price of an offer of 100 Mbit/s or more down 76% under a plan to retire the copper network by the end of 2027, carried on a nationwide 400G optical backbone project launched with Huawei in February 2025. Mobile reach was close to complete before 5G arrived — 3G and 4G networks covered 99.1% of the population in 2024 — and Algérie Télécom plans 345 more base stations across 44 provinces, alongside a programme to connect 4,500 more localities by 2027 (February 2026).

76.9% of the population used the internet in early 2025, with mobile connections equal to 116% of the population, and 84% of adults owned a smartphone (2024). Algeria climbed fifteen places to 74th in the ITU's ICT Development Index published in June 2025, Ookla placed Algiers 48th in the world for mobile speed at 163.31 Mbps in May 2026, a rise of 68 places, and mobile communications recorded the largest ten-year gain of any of the 96 indicators the 2024 IIAG scores for Algeria, reaching 81.7 of 100 in 2023.

Domestic interconnection has not moved at that pace. An exchange point, AlgIX, is registered in Algiers, but Algérie Télécom's own network record lists no active public peering (2026). New international capacity is at the intention stage — Algérie Télécom and Sparkle have signed a memorandum of understanding on a submarine cable linking Italy to Algeria (July 2025), and Algeria and Tunisia agreed in June 2026 to plan a second cable linking both to Italy and to upgrade the terrestrial link between them — while ARPCE has put two satellite-network licences out to tender (April 2026). The incumbents' own terms are unsettled: the Council of Government examined draft decrees renewing the Mobilis and Djezzy cellular licences on 23 July 2026.

Data Storage

The state moved its own services onto infrastructure it owns in July 2026: President Tebboune inaugurated the National Digital Services Center on 5 July, two high-availability data centres in active-active architecture, connected to 46 government ministries and hosting the national public services portal and the national database. The Mohammadia site was certified to Uptime Institute Tier III Design in February 2026 and the Blida site in September 2026, certifications of the design rather than of the constructed facilities, which the High Commission says it is still working towards. The two sites, at Mohammadia in Algiers and at Blida, were built by the Chinese vendor Huawei, and the Mohammadia centre carries the national cloud and the Dzair digital services platform.

Earlier state sites include a data centre opened at Constantine in February 2023, and the estate is still being extended into new tenants and new workloads. Parliament signed an agreement in June 2026 to run its own systems on the state's sovereign cloud. Construction of a national artificial-intelligence high-performance computing centre at Oran began in March 2025, intended to give researchers, universities and startups GPU computing. Beyond the government data centres, CERIST launched a cloud-computing platform on OpenStack and Kubernetes in March 2025 and Djezzy announced an artificial-intelligence cloud platform with Algeria Venture and Taubyte in April 2026. Private operators run their own sites: ICOSNET's colocation data centre at Oran is one, and Ayrade, which operates two data centres under a 2024 cloud authorisation, offered 20% of its capital on the Algiers stock exchange in June 2026 to fund 294 servers.

Localisation is the rule around it: personal data on Algerian data subjects must be held on servers inside the country (2024) — a duty a draft platform-regulation bill would extend to the large foreign platforms themselves, requiring covered platforms to store user data on national territory or in approved data centres. Security of the estate is assigned rather than left open: the High Commission for Digitalisation is responsible for ensuring the National Data Centre and National Cloud meet national cybersecurity standards.

Energy

Algeria's grid reaches everyone and runs on gas. World Bank data put both urban and rural electricity access at 100% in 2023, with no meaningful divide between them, and the 2024 IIAG scores access to energy at 99.7 of 100 for 2023, 4th of 54 African states and effectively unchanged over the decade — one of the country's highest-scoring governance measures on any dimension. Renewables supplied about 1% of generation in 2023, 926 GWh of 95,830 GWh, the rest overwhelmingly natural gas, and power is cheap, at about €0.028 per kWh (2021). The gap is off-grid provision: the World Bank's RISE assessment records no policy framework for off-grid electrification (2025). For the state's own hosting, the national digital services centre is fed from several sources, its generators, cooling and electrical circuits duplicated, with battery banks and standby generators to take over on a failure of the Sonelgaz grid (July 2026).

Technical Capacity

Operational work has begun to move onshore: Djezzy deepened its partnership with Qvantel through a new managed-services hub in Algeria in March 2026, shifting parts of its business-support operations into the country. The state's own compute base for researchers and startups began construction at Oran in March 2025, and the interior ministry runs its identity and travel-document systems as integrator rather than buyer of turnkey solutions, its central collection and processing systems developed and administered by its own engineers and its blank secure documents manufactured in the country (May 2026). Public training effort runs through the security side, with a second cohort of information-systems security officers trained at Sidi Abdellah in June 2026 under the defence ministry's security agency, and policy advice through a scientific and technical committee attached to the High Commission for Digitalisation. Algeria had published no assessment of the size or composition of its digital workforce as at August 2026.

Cybersecurity

Algeria gained its first sectoral incident-response capability in June 2026: MPT-CERT, a computer emergency response centre for the post and telecommunications sector, was inaugurated on 15 June to handle monitoring, alerting and incident response, with South Korea supporting Algeria's cyber-defence capacity through KOICA.

Defence holds the centre of the system. The Information Systems Security Agency sits under the Ministry of National Defence and is charged with implementing national cyber policy, monitoring cyberspace and defending critical state infrastructure, and it works on live civilian systems: the national digital identity layer behind the Dzair Digital Services portal was tested and validated by the agency before the portal's launch was approved (2026). A national information-systems security strategy for 2025 to 2029 was approved by presidential decree gazetted on 30 December 2025, and supervision of the national data-governance arrangement is divided between the National Council for Information-Systems Security, the data-protection authority and the security agency. The framing throughout is digital sovereignty (April 2026).

Below the national bodies, the obligation now reaches every institution. A presidential decree gazetted in January 2026 requires every public institution, administration and body to create a structure responsible for information-systems security and personal-data protection, organisationally independent of the body's own IT function and attached directly to the head of the institution, with duties spanning a risk map, continuous audit and monitoring,

immediate incident notification, security clauses in subcontracting, user training and coordination with the security agency and the data-protection authority. Its own commencement runs through further texts, the content and organisation of the new posts left to a joint finance and public-service order and implementation to a public-service instruction.

The public face of all this is recent and thin: Algiers hosted the first Cyber Security Days from 14 to 16 June 2026, a national event on cybersecurity, digital sovereignty and innovation.

DPI

Data Exchange

On 20 September 2026 the Council of Ministers ordered a presidential decree on a secure digital interoperability plan between state bodies, setting the missions and representation of the sectoral bodies under the High Commissioner for Digitalisation and extending interoperability to the wilayas.

Algeria's pension fund stopped asking retirees for a paper certificate of life in May 2026: the certificate is replaced by facial recognition through a mobile application.

The legal basis arrived only at the end of 2025. Presidential Decree 25-320 of 30 December 2025 constitutes a système national d'interopérabilité as the exclusive channel for digital data exchange between public institutions, carried on a secure national interconnection network kept separate from the internet and set up by the High Commission for Digitalisation, which also administers the system. The decree's duties on public bodies begin only from the date the Commission publishes the two data référentiels it requires, so exclusivity is not yet a running duty; administrations were given one month from 12 July 2026 to interconnect their systems with the national government data centres, a deadline that passed with no completion reported. State media describes the separate network as IRIES, linking more than 100 ministries and public bodies to the national data centres outside the public internet (September 2026).

What actually crosses is narrower than the framework, and older than it. Citizens no longer submit civil status documents the national automated civil status register already holds, because authorised institutions including the Ministry of Justice retrieve them electronically (2023), and a single electronic company-creation portal run by the trade register enrols a new business simultaneously with the tax authority, the CASNOS and CNAS social security funds and the statistics office under one common identifier issued within three days (2023). Public bodies are required to connect their systems to the automated identification-number system under Executive Decree 23-316, letting them retrieve identity data electronically instead of asking holders of biometric documents for paper (December 2025). The tax, customs, human resource, social insurance and procurement systems each exchange data with other government systems, while the whole-of-government interoperability framework was still in draft in 2025 and the exchange platform it would govern only partly in use.

Dzair Services, presented as the single national platform resting on an interoperability system for automatic exchange of verified data, was still being extended in October 2025, and Algeria joined the 50-in-5 digital public infrastructure campaign in March 2026 as its fifteenth African member. Published analysis in Le Matin d'Algérie holds that forms are moved online without changing the logics that produce them, leaving the citizen to bridge administrations that still cannot talk to each other.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Algeria is extending the credential it already has rather than issuing a new one: the planned national digital identity system is linked to the existing biometric national identity card, the approach carried into the law on electronic trust services and electronic identification adopted in February 2026.

The Numéro d'Identification National, instituted by executive decree in 2010, is generated automatically from civil status data at the point of birth registration and is the key linking the biometric identity card, the passport, the driving licence and other identity-dependent systems; foreign nationals born in Algeria and legally resident there qualify for the number too, though the biometric card is issued to Algerian citizens, those abroad applying after consular registration (2024). It carries two fingerprints in a match-on-card application and a facial photograph, held both on the card and in the Ministry of the Interior's central database, with no iris capture (2026); more than 40 million cards had been issued by May 2026, ten years after issuance began in January 2016, and the identification number keys the link between the civil-status register, the fingerprint system and the central issuing system, on the interior ministry's own count.

Underneath sits the country's strongest institutional showing of any kind: civil registration is the highest score Algeria records on any of the Ibrahim Index's 96 indicators, 100 out of 100 in 2023 and first of 54 African states.

The card opens a widening set of doors. It is the primary know-your-customer document under the 2005 anti-money-laundering law, with financial institutions verifying identity against it, a passport or a driving licence; transfers of vehicle ownership require it (April 2026). Around it the state has added other digital services: the telecoms regulator's electronic authentication and signature service went live in 2025; the social insurance fund began issuing an electronic card giving destitute people without social cover access to medicines in January 2026; and remote renewal of biometric passports opened to the diaspora in June 2026, starting at the Paris consulate general.

Its reach stops short of systems people use most. Healthcare runs on a separate card issued by the social insurance fund rather than on the identity card, the civil service human resource system uses its own identifiers rather than the national identity number (2025). The digitalisation commission set out how the national digital identity is obtained, by registration and appointment at the commune, activation and verification against the holder's biometric data (2026).

Digital Payments and Fintech

Electronic payments in Algeria rose 46% during 2025 to 939 billion dinars, around USD 7 billion — a rise the state news agency attributes largely to public administrations moving their own collections online rather than to people paying each other or their shopkeepers.

The instruments are spread far more widely than the habit. The card base passed 22 million by the end of March 2026, nearly 18 million of them Edahabia cards issued by the postal operator, while the instant mobile payment system DZ Mob Pay held 95,014 personal accounts at the end of 2025 and most person-to-business and business-to-business transactions stayed in cash (2024). Access to banking services is among Algeria's ten worst-scoring governance indicators, 19.6 out of 100 in 2023 and lower than a decade earlier, and the head of the national consumer-protection body for electronic commerce describes online selling as running largely through social media pages outside the 2018 e-commerce law and settling cash on delivery (2026).

Where money does move digitally, a rule has often removed the alternative. Electronic payment through the tax portal Jibayatic is mandatory for taxpayers under the Directorate of Large Enterprises and optional for the real, simplified-real and flat-rate regimes (August 2026), and the tax administration's first published guide lists 17 causes

of payment rejection and states that a rejected taxpayer cannot retry electronically but must attend a local tax office. Transfers go the same way: the unemployment allowance of DA 15,000 a month reaches more than 1.9 million jobseekers through their postal accounts (2023). The AADL3 social-housing programme takes payment by Edahabia or CIB card with no cash route (2025), and traffic fines have been payable electronically since May 2025, with 2,000 terminals issued to police and gendarmerie in a first phase.

The rule-making machinery was assembled late. Règlement 26-01 of 31 May 2026 fixes the composition and working arrangements of the National Payments Committee, whose main task is to draft a national strategy for developing payment instruments; three security services sit on it, and it owes an annual report on the state of payment instruments. Operating rules for payment service providers were issued in August 2025, and a mobile operator's subsidiary was authorised to constitute itself as one in September 2026, with its licence still to be sought, and the central bank joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System in August 2025 as its eighteenth country. About 23 million payment cards were in circulation and 126,000 payment terminals installed at the end of August 2026, against 78,000 terminals in December 2025, on the interbank payments body's count.

Registries

Algeria began a nationwide rollout of the AMLAK electronic land system in January 2026, to replace paper land titles progressively with an electronic format, and a decree published on 27 January 2026 formalised the electronic land booklet — over a base in which around 60% of private land is not legally registered and holds no title at all (2024).

AMLAK is to connect every cadastral and land registry office to a single system, and notaries have had direct online access to the cadastral and land databases since an interoperability agreement of August 2025 between the finance ministry, the national assets directorate and the justice ministry, though cadastral delimitation is not complete nationwide (2025): field operations had covered more than 75% of urban land and 98% of rural land at the end of 2024.

Company registration is the furthest along: the CNRC runs Sidjilcom as a fully digital trade register providing online registration, extracts and legal information (2026), its company-creation portal sends one filing to the register, the tax administration, both social-security funds and the statistics office, and issues a common identifier within three days of approval, and 173,651 new registrations were recorded against 125,195 strike-offs during 2025.

The register therefore grew by a net 48,456 businesses across 2025.

The Registre National de la Population is keyed by the national identification number and links the identity card, passport, driving licence, vehicle registration and civil status records across all 1,541 communes (2019), and the national automated civil status register holds around 102 million digitised historic acts — 68.65 million births, 17.70 million deaths and 15.64 million marriages (2019). A draft civil-status law to strengthen the framework for digitising civil status was examined by the government on 3 April 2024, and the Council of Ministers sent it back for revision in May 2025; no later stage is held. Birth registration is 99.6% complete (2019), while registration of refugee and asylum-seeker children falls well short of that (2025).

Elsewhere the registers are complete but unconnected. 24,351,551 voters were registered for the September 2024 presidential election against a voting-age population of 30,243,035, and the roll is continuous and electronically updated but is not integrated with the biometric identity system (2026), even as the electoral authority ran an online portal for registration, removal and updates and a central hub monitoring roll revision across all 1,541 municipalities ahead of the July 2026 legislative election. The national agricultural registry was fully digitised by November 2024, with electronic farmer cards issued across all 58 wilayas, while the national addressing reference was still in an initial phase in four pilot wilayas (2025).

Sectoral management information systems

A national justice portal has tracked cases and issued simple copies of judgments from any court since May 2024, and since February 2026 lawyers have received electronically signed certified copies online within 24 hours. In September 2026 the electronic window for the administrative courts was extended to the administrative courts of appeal and the Council of State.

Tax is following. Electronic filing through Jibayatic, compulsory only for taxpayers of the Directorate of Large Enterprises until the end of 2025, was extended to the other tax structures by an instruction of 6 May 2026, with online payment optional for their taxpayers. What it collects for remains weak: tax and revenue mobilisation is Algeria's poorest public administration measure on the Ibrahim Index, 32.4 out of 100 in 2023, 44th of 54 African states and down over the decade.

The line ministries have built quickly and separately. The health ministry has completed a national platform for real-time data exchange between hospitals alongside an electronic medical record rollout and a new National Digital Health Agency, but the unification of CNAS and CASNOS insurance data that full integration requires remains a costed and unmet reform (2026). The ministry began deploying its own electronic medical record to more than 2,500 facilities across the 69 wilayas in July 2026 and set 15 November 2026 as a non-extendable deadline for every public establishment, on a single national patient number, while the national agency for health digitisation was dissolved by decree in February 2026. Customs clears on ALCES, built on Korea's UNI-PASS, which had handled 168,000 declarations, 70% of filings, by September 2024. The national agricultural information system launched in June 2026 with a harvest-monitoring module, its land-register, livestock, input, financing, market and climate modules to be deployed in phases, and the solidarity sector's integrated platform was piloted in two municipalities in March 2026. The higher education ministry counts 73 digital service platforms integrated into its own information system (2026), and the employment agency's WassitOnline, live since 2018, remains a standalone sectoral service (2024).

The core financial back office is further behind the sectoral systems. The civil service human resource system runs on custom software, and the government payroll system is still being implemented, as is the treasury single account, used by only some ministries, departments and agencies (2025). The integrated budget management system went live in the customs, treasury, budget and tax directorates in a first phase from late 2024, hosted in the finance ministry's Tier III-certified data centre, with every public administration to follow by 2027. Below the national platforms, most private clinics were still keeping paper patient folders and handwritten appointment books in 2026.

Of the ten core government back-office systems the World Bank's GovTech Maturity Index assesses, Algeria had seven in use, two still being implemented and one absent as at 2025. The health ministry held a day for the adoption of its national digital health strategy.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Algeria has begun closing paper channels rather than only adding digital ones: vehicle registration went entirely digital on 5 April 2026, ending acceptance of manual applications at local offices, and from 1 August 2026 every services-import application must be lodged, processed and tracked through the foreign trade ministry's platform. In August the interior minister named all-digital vehicle registration among his ministry's stalled projects and ordered rapid correction of faults in the system.

Dzair Services was announced in October 2025 as a single window aggregating public services on an interoperability system, with 46 ministries and agencies already connected by fibre, and the Council of Ministers approved the operational launch of the Dzair Digital Services portal on 25 May 2026, with a digital identity layer tied to the biometric identity card as the gating credential, hosted in the national digital services centre inaugurated at Mohammadia in July 2026 and supported by a free helpline running seven days a week. The High Commission put

the portal at 150 services on 9 September 2026, against 21 at launch. It passed one million registered users and five million visitors about ten weeks after its 5 July 2026 launch, on the High Commission's own count, and the Prime Minister has instructed every administration to accept documents issued through it.

The apostille system took effect on 9 July 2026, replacing the multi-step classic legalisation chain for documents destined for use abroad, after accession to the Hague convention in August 2025; higher-education documents can be certified through it for recognition in more than 120 countries (July 2026). Lawyers have obtained certified copies of court decisions online since February 2026. Public procurement has its own portal, launched under Law 23-12 with its content fixed by an arrêté of 4 February 2026, for tenders, debarment lists, electronic bids and electronic signature. A national police platform for declaring lost documents remotely opened in November 2025.

The UN's 2024 e-government survey placed Algeria 116th of 193 states at 0.5956. The national service portal is transactional and reaches ordinary users (2025), while the economist Omar Berkouk warns that transformation is being counted in initiatives launched rather than in processing times cut or applications completed online (August 2026).

At least 19 distinct national digital public-service systems entered service or were announced between March 2025 and August 2026, spanning tax, notarial, judicial, land, commercial-registry, trade, health, agriculture, higher-education, SME, social-security and policing functions.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Most Algerian municipalities still have no functioning website of their own (2025). The digital state below the national level is largely something built downward into the communes rather than by them: connection of communes to the national civil-status platform was still being extended in 2023, and the national addressing database run by the interior ministry with the space agency was still working outward from its pilot wilayas in 2025.

Where something distinctively municipal has appeared, an operator has supplied it: Ooredoo launched a smart-city pilot in Sétif combining 5G and IoT services in February 2026. "Electronic municipalities" are a named strand of the e-government strategy, which is a different thing from communes running systems of their own.

Rural digital data capture

Not one of the four indicators in the Rural Economy sub-category of the 2024 Ibrahim Index of African Governance could be scored for Algeria, part of a wider blank of 18 of the index's 96 indicators on which the country carries no data. That is not for want of registers. The national agricultural registry has been digitised, and the agriculture ministry has launched an integrated national information system, to which farm-register, land-register, livestock and support-programme modules are being added (June 2026). What sits underneath is thinner: the World Bank's record shows no agricultural census in Algeria in the past twenty years, so the sector's digital picture rests on what claimants register rather than on any recent enumeration of the ground.

Capture at the point where the person or the asset actually is remains mostly manual. Primary schools use electronic administration only in limited, specific areas (2024). Most private clinics still kept paper patient folders in 2026, and the national electronic patient record was in planning and early rollout through 2026. The gendarmerie has 1,233 territorial brigades at commune level.

The distinction that gets lost here is between reaching a rural area and recording anything in it. 3G and 4G networks reach almost the entire population (2024), and the national police's platform for declaring a lost document remotely at any time, opened in November 2025, is meant to serve people in remote regions too. The opening of satellite-ISP licensing was justified by reaching remote and isolated areas and supporting IoT in agriculture, mining and transport (April 2026), which describes a prospect for capture in the interior rather than a system already running there.

Technology

AI

Algeria has an implementation roadmap for artificial intelligence in public services before it has a published strategy. A joint inter-ministerial roadmap was agreed to deploy the technology across public services, prioritising sovereign open-source models, high-performance computing centres, national data storage and stronger safeguards for public-sector applications, with intensive university training programmes, a dedicated research centre and specialised research units, and a joint monitoring committee to oversee delivery against a stated timeline (reported 12 August 2026). A second coordination meeting on 8 September 2026 set up five thematic commissions, a national AI and data research centre and a target of 50,000 AI specialists by 2030. The strategy underneath it was still a draft as at May 2026, reviewed at a government meeting with its action plans to follow only once it is adopted, no adoption instrument is on file, and legislation on the ethical use of the technology was reported in preparation in November 2025. What is settled is the machinery around the policy rather than the policy itself. Algeria's 2025 submission to the UN Commission on Science and Technology for Development names a National School of Artificial Intelligence and the Sidi Abdellah technology park among its specialised digital institutions, and the country has taken a position abroad, arguing at the UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance in Geneva for practical, implementable governance measures in July 2026, with accession to an international artificial-intelligence body among the initiatives recorded over the following month.

What is running sits mostly with operators, universities and a new cluster rather than inside the administration; the exception on record is the higher education ministry's adviser built on a large language model to answer questions on its regulations, launched in April 2025. Algérie Télécom's "AI for digital inclusion" project took a WSIS Forum certificate of appreciation in the ICT-infrastructure category in Geneva in July 2026, from a field of 1,595 projects across 122 countries. Algeria has opened a first technology and innovation centre for virtual-education systems, applying artificial intelligence to distance and online teaching (June 2026), and launched a first national artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity startup cluster at Sidi Abdellah in April 2026. The state's own compute is a separate track: construction of the artificial-intelligence computing centre at Oran began in March 2025. Demand is ahead of both — artificial intelligence is the most-chosen track in the national digital empowerment programme (May 2026).

ICT Industry

The state electronics manufacturer ENIE is now accredited to install and maintain every electronic payment terminal in the country, whatever its brand or origin, where it previously serviced only its own (July 2026), and the interior ministry builds and runs its own identity-document systems and manufactures blank secure documents in the country (May 2026). Domestic and foreign capacity sit side by side across the sector. On the domestic side, SATICOM, the Algérie Télécom subsidiary building digital solutions for public administration, was held up as home-grown capacity during a ministerial inspection in September 2025; work on a structured video-game and e-sports industry began with a ministerial consultation in February 2026 and reached a preliminary agreement with Roblox to train young developers, announced in October 2026; and the state buys from small firms as well as its own, with technology startups engaged in the delivery of public services, financing or support arrangements in place and public-private partnerships used for online delivery (2025). On the consumer side, the super-app Yassir is buying the

Uno hypermarket chain to extend its payment, delivery and e-commerce services into retail (March 2026). The core of the network remains foreign-built and foreign-run — the national 400G optical backbone project was launched with Huawei, and one operator's business-support operations run through a managed-services hub with Qvantel (March 2026).

Innovation ecosystem

Algeria placed 115th of 133 economies in WIPO's Global Innovation Index 2024, and what the two years since have added is institutions rather than measured output. At least four AfriLabs member innovation hubs are active — Technopole Constantine Hill, the PAUWES Entrepreneurship Hub, IncubeMe Algeria and Sylabs (2025). Algeria launched its first national artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity startup cluster at the Sidi Abdellah science and technology hub on 18 April 2026, pairing universities, research centres and firms. The public research centre CERIST launched a cloud platform, a drone system and a startup incubator in March 2025, and in June 2026 two bodies, a High Council of Scientists and a national archaeology agency, were announced as being created under the Presidency.

Government's own machinery for absorbing new things is the thinner half: Algeria has a public-sector innovation strategy or a programme but not both, and a dedicated unit covering public-service innovation that is planned or in progress rather than established (2025). The incentives run ahead of it. Initial public offering fees for startups have been waived until 2028 to bring young technology companies onto the Algiers exchange (February 2026), and the knowledge-economy policy carries a startup target for 2029. The convening is continental as well as domestic: the AfCFTA Secretariat and Algeria are partnering on the Africa Start-up Conference 2026, and Algiers hosted the first Cyber Security Days on 14 June 2026 on cybersecurity, digital sovereignty and innovation. What the hubs, clusters and incentives have produced was not established as at August 2026.

Capacity

Literacy

Education is the fastest-deteriorating of Algeria's sixteen governance sub-categories, down 14.3 points over 2014-2023 to 56.6 of 100 and 22nd of 54 African states, moving against the country's overall governance trajectory (2023). The fall is not in schooling itself, where all four measures rose over the same decade and rank high on the continent: enrolment 78.9 of 100 and second of 54, completion 81.8 and eighth, equality in education 68.9 and seventh, and quality 53.6 and twelfth (2023).

Above school level the intake is unusually technical. Science and engineering accounted for 34.2% of tertiary graduates, around eighth in the world on that measure, with gross tertiary enrolment at 52.6% (2021).

That record does not carry across into the systems people are asked to use: digital-skills gaps remain a recognised challenge (2024). Where schooling has itself been digitised, the 2024-25 programme moved first-grade enrolment to an online portal for parents and put tablets and digital textbooks into a limited number of selected schools, chosen partly on whether their electricity supply was reliable, rather than digitising day-to-day record capture inside them.

The state's answer for adults is the "7.77" national digital empowerment programme, open to citizens aged 7 to 77 and aimed at raising basic digital skills across the population (May 2026). Digital skills provision for citizens is recorded as fee-based on the World Bank's GovTech Maturity Index 2025 update.

Training and skills

Artificial intelligence is what Algerians are signing up to learn: of 64,508 registrations for the "7.77" programme, 19,691 chose the AI track, level with productivity tools at 19,576 and ahead of professional cybersecurity (9,678), digital entrepreneurship (9,083) and digital discovery (8,237) (May 2026).

Registration reached all 58 wilayas by May 2026, and registrants chose remote delivery over in-person by 80.4% to 19.6%, with 61.4% aged 23 to 45 and a further 20.4% aged 18 to 22, against 3,199 children aged 7 to 10 and 181 people aged 61 to 77 (May 2026). A programme branded seven to seventy-seven is in practice carried by working-age adults teaching themselves at home.

Training aimed at the state's own staff is narrower. Algeria has a public sector digital skills strategy or programme, but not both, its content recorded as advanced data science and data literacy (2025).

The specialised pipelines are small and tied to named roles. The national higher school of computer science, founded in 1969, graduates around 180 engineers a year (2021). A second cohort of information systems security officers was trained at Sidi Abdellah under the Ministry of National Defence's Information Systems Security Agency, framed as building the human capacity for digital sovereignty (June 2026). A twelve-week national artificial-intelligence vocational training track launched in April 2026, alongside a first business incubator at the vocational training institute's digital-economy centre.

The universities are next. The higher education minister announced on 25 July 2026 that from the 2026-27 academic year every student's learning pathway will be steered by an intelligent assistant matching modules to their competences and career goals, alongside a large language model for lecturers that generates exercises and marks student answers, and the first technology and innovation centre for virtual-education systems opened in June 2026.

Research institutions

Steering of the research base is moving to the centre of government: in June 2026 a High Council of Scientists and Researchers and a national archaeology agency were announced as being created under the Presidency. The institutions doing the work are public and older: CERIST, the state research centre for scientific and technical information, put its own cloud platform and a startup incubator into service in March 2025, and the national higher school of computer science runs a doctoral programme and two research laboratories (2021). Government's own account to the UN names the National School of Artificial Intelligence and the Sidi Abdellah technology park among its specialised digital institutions (2025), where a first AI and cybersecurity startup cluster pairing universities, research centres and firms opened on 18 April 2026. The AI high-performance computing centre whose foundation stone was laid at Oran in March 2025 is intended to give researchers and academic institutions high-performance computing of their own.

Inclusion

Access to services

Algeria ranks fourth in Africa on the Ibrahim Index's assessment of how evenly public services are provided across groups, at 72.7 of 100 in 2023, with the companion measure of women's access to public services at 89.0 after an 18.0-point rise over the decade. Set against that, the same profile puts legal protection against discrimination at the bottom of its range, unchanged across the same ten years (2023): even provision rests on how services are run rather than on a protection a person could invoke when they are not.

What a person must hold is the real gate. The national identification number is open to foreign nationals born in Algeria and legally resident there under Executive Decree 10-210, but the biometric identity card is issued to Algerian citizens, and the solidarity allowance is open only to Algerian nationals resident in the country (2024). For people outside the citizen register the position is measured: UNHCR's 2025-2027 strategy records 75-80% of refugees and asylum-seekers holding legally recognised identity documents, and birth registration for refugee and asylum-seeker children under five at 65% against a 97% target (2025).

Channels for complaint exist, sector by sector: the ombudsman's grievance-register platform, Tansik, links local and central administrations (2024), and the posts and telecommunications ministry opened a requests portal in February 2025; a decree of January 2026 requires ministries to give pupils and students with specific needs adapted access to information and communication technologies. Where the state has moved, it has moved by credential: an electronic card launched in January 2026 gives the most vulnerable beneficiaries access to medication. The friction sits further down. Digital-skills gaps persist (2024); standardised addressing was still at a pilot stage in a handful of wilayas (2025); fewer than 10% of merchants operate an electronic payment terminal (May 2026), with most transactions still settling in cash (2024). And a digital channel can be the only channel: the foreign-trade ministry's services-import platform became the exclusive route for those procedures from 1 August 2026, where the free helpline stood up for the national services portal at the end of July 2026 at least gives a user who cannot work the screen someone to call.

Digital divides

Algeria's divide is geographic before it is anything else: digital services are concentrated in urban areas, connectivity across the Sahara and other remote areas lags, and the Digital Algeria 2030 strategy acknowledges the rural access gap (2025). The state has instruments pointed straight at it — a universal-service programme for low-density zones, a satellite-ISP market opened on the stated rationale of reaching remote and isolated areas, and a state-operator 4G build extending coverage to remote areas. A ministerial order of 3 September 2026 fixed the calendar of the universal-service tender for mobile coverage of low-density localities, 3,000 of them in lots open to licensed mobile operators.

The older infrastructure divide has already closed. Electricity reaches urban and rural households alike (2023), and most of the population uses the internet (2025). What has not closed is the divide inside the state: most municipalities still have no functioning website (2025), which leaves a resident of an interior commune further from an online administration than the connection figures imply, whatever the network reaches.

One line of exclusion cuts across the geography: digital skills programmes reach citizens on a fee-paying basis (2025), which sorts entry to the training by income — even as the national digital empowerment programme has drawn enrolments from every wilaya (May 2026). The sharpest statement of where this ends up was put in the Algerian press in July 2026: unequal access to infrastructure, training and equipment turns a digital-only administration into a selective bureaucracy, and moving forms online without transparency or firm data guarantees reads to users as one more constraint rather than a service.

Data

National statistics

Algeria has held no agricultural census in the past twenty years, and its survey programme is thinner still: no labour force survey and no business or establishment survey in the past ten years, and a single household survey in that decade against two agricultural surveys and three or more health surveys (2023). The sixth general population and housing census ran from 25 September to 16 October 2022, its 53,493 enumerators working on 53,000 4G tablets; the gap falls on labour, enterprise and agriculture statistics.

The World Bank's five-pillar reading of the system puts data use and data products in the 70-89% band while data services, data sources and data infrastructure each fall in the 50-69% band (2023). The weakness is upstream of the numbers, in the collecting rather than the publishing, which is the same account the census and survey record gives.

Algeria scores 47.2 of 100 for the capacity of its statistical system, 29th of 54 African states and 4.4 points better than a decade earlier (2023). That mid-table placing sits well below the country's 18th on the same index's overall governance ranking — the statistical system is a laggard relative to the state around it, not in step with it. The same profile cannot score Algeria's rural economy at all, for want of the underlying indicators.

The registration base beneath all this is sound: birth registration is close to complete, and the statistics office's annual demography report, built from an exhaustive survey of the communes' civil-status services, counted 895,000 live births and 192,000 deaths in 2023 and 46.7 million residents at 1 January 2024; and the state has been standing up sectoral administrative systems quickly, from agriculture to small and medium enterprises to market supply and prices. Those systems count what passes through them, which is not the same population a survey samples.

Open data

Open Data Watch's 2024 inventory scores Algeria zero out of ten in seven categories — digital-economy statistics, built environment, pollution, crime, food security and nutrition, gender statistics and poverty. Its highest anywhere in the inventory are balance of payments at 5.5 and population and vital statistics at 5.0, barely past the midpoint of the scale; the bulk of the rest cluster between 3.0 and 4.0, with money and banking and natural resources at 4.0 and national accounts, labour, energy and education outcomes at 3.0. Health scores lower than any of them, facilities and outcomes at 2.5 each (2024).

Algeria does run an open government data portal publishing basic information and datasets (2025). A portal at that level is somewhere to put data rather than evidence that data has been put there, and the inventory scores are the measure of what arrived.

Every measure in the World Bank's 2025 index that asks whether Algeria publishes the documents, assessments or operating arrangements behind its digital government is answered no.

Access to the state's own records has improved from a low base: Disclosure of Public Records rose 8.5 points to 32.3 of 100, 30th of 54, and Accessibility of Public Records 4.6 points to 28.9, 29th over 2014-2023, leaving accountability and transparency among Algeria's worst-scoring areas of governance (2023).

The presidential decree of 30 December 2025 that set the national framework for public data governance has been criticised for omitting open data and reuse (January 2026), and a national data catalogue is targeted for launch in the second half of 2026. The Prime Minister launched the data-governance framework on 9 February 2026, promising standardised exchange channels and a unified national database of data sources. Where routine publication does

exist it is narrow and sits outside central government: GIE Monetique puts out annual and monthly statistics across five payment channels, while the Justice Ministry's February 2026 system for certified copies of court decisions opened them to lawyers rather than to the public.

Use of satellite data

ARPCE put two satellite-network licences out to tender in April 2026, opening Algeria's satellite communications market to competition. The regulator's stated purpose is reaching remote areas and carrying machine-to-machine traffic for farming, mining and transport — satellites as a delivery route for connectivity, not as a source of data about the country. Earth observation runs separately, project by project: the space agency put a second high-resolution observation satellite into orbit in January 2026, presented crop-monitoring pilots at Sidi Bel Abbes and Mostaganem in August 2023, and the agriculture ministry's WaPOR unit maps irrigation water use in the western Mitidja from FAO satellite data (2025); the meteorological office receives satellite imagery at Oran and Constantine (2018). No national geospatial data policy is on file.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

No American government programme or United States platform operator had a stated role in Algeria's digital estate as at August 2026.

China activities

Both layers of the state's digital estate come from the same Chinese vendor: the twin active-active data centres behind government digital services, and the national 400G optical backbone project Algérie Télécom launched with it in February 2025. Algeria and Huawei were in discussion on artificial intelligence and the digital economy in April 2026. Algeria also signed in July 2026 as a founding member of a 29-country artificial-intelligence organisation headquartered in Shanghai, with no obligation, contribution or programme of work stated.

EU activities

Europe's part in Algeria's digital plans is Italy's, and it is on paper. Algeria and Italy signed a memorandum of understanding on innovation, digital transformation and smart industry during President Tebboune's visit to Rome in July 2025, and in the same month Algérie Télécom and Sparkle set out an intention to lay a new submarine cable between Italy and Algeria. Both are memoranda, which commit neither side to build anything.

Gulf/UAE activities

Qatar's Ooredoo group runs one of Algeria's three mobile networks: its 2025 results count Ooredoo Algeria among the group's leading growth contributors, with a 5G licence secured in July 2025 and a fintech licence application in Algeria still advancing. Oman offered partnerships in artificial intelligence, data centres, fintech and space at a meeting in July 2026, with no instrument concluded. No Emirati operator, and no Gulf-financed data centre or government platform, is on record as at September 2026.

India activities

India had no state or corporate presence in Algeria's technology build through to August 2026.

Digital sovereignty

Every intervention on Algeria's 5G networks must be made from inside the country: the licences of November 2025 require it to be done from Algerian territory under the licensee's supervision, bar the subcontracting of subscribers' personal-data processing, and let firms outside majority-Algerian ownership supply or work on active infrastructure, the 5G core included, only on a proven shortage of local skills and with the regulator's approval.

Hosting on national territory is written in sector by sector. Law 26-02 of February 2026 requires all data collected by trust-service providers to be hosted in Algeria, with transfers abroad allowed within their activity (article 27), and the central bank requires every payment service provider to host its payment platform and its redundancies in the country (article 4 of règlement 25-02). For the state itself, the World Bank's 2025 GovTech index records a government-cloud hosting policy of keeping data inside the country.

The state's own data is moving onto the national estate by agreement, ministry by ministry: the health ministry signed on 5 December 2025 to take cloud services from the Centre national algérien des services numériques. The terms on which the Huawei contracts for the Mohammadia and Blida data centres govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

The AI layer runs on open software: the national AI school's GPU centre, equipped with H100, L40S and A40 series processors, gives students and researchers model training on open-source software (July 2025). Across the continent, African ICT ministers adopted in Algiers in December 2025 a declaration on fair digital platforms, calling for coordinated negotiation with global platforms and platform contributions to local infrastructure and skills.

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